

Figure 2.16 Electrical bulbs with power rating

Usually these voltage rating refers AC RMS voltages. For a given bulb, if the voltage drop across the bulb is greater than voltage rating, the bulb will fuse.

Using Ohm's law, power delivered to the resistance R is expressed in other forms

$$P = IV = I\,(IR) = I^2R \qquad (2.33)$$

$$P = IV = \frac{V}{R}V = \frac{V^2}{R} \qquad (2.34)$$



The Tamilnadu Electricity Board is charging for the amount of energy you use and not for the power. A current of 1A flowing through a potential difference of 1V produces a power of 1W.



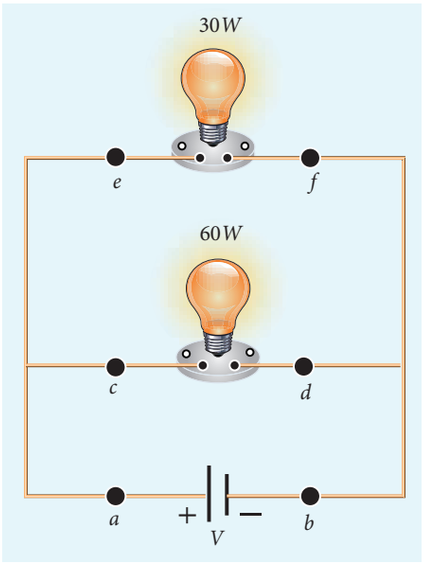
The electrical power produced (dissipated) by a resistor is I^2R. It depends on the square of the current. Hence, if current is doubled, the power will increase by four times. Similar explanation holds true for voltage also.

The total electrical energy used by any device is obtained by multiplying the power and duration of the time when it is ON. If the power is in watts and the time is in seconds, the energy will be in joules. In practice, electrical energy is measured in kilowatt hour (kWh). 1 kWh is known as 1 unit of electrical energy.

(1 kWh = 1000 Wh = (1000 W) (3600 s) = 3.6×10^6 J)

EXAMPLE 2.15

A battery of voltage V is connected to 30 W bulb and 60 W bulb as shown in the figure. (a) Identify brightest bulb (b) which bulb has greater resistance? (c) Suppose the two bulbs are connected in series, which bulb will glow brighter?



Solution

(a) The power delivered by the battery $P = VI$. Since the bulbs are connected in parallel, the voltage drop across each bulb is the same. If the voltage is kept fixed, then the power is directly proportional to current ($P \propto I$). So 60 W bulb draws twice as much as current as 30 W and it will glow brighter than 30 W bulb.

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